# The Little Ledge

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 8

The Mill's delivery ledge was full of round tins. Nib balanced an invitation on top. It slid, glided down a curved lid, and landed neatly in his lap. He looked pleased to have caught it and less pleased to have become the delivery shelf.

“A letter in my lap,” Nib observed ruefully. “A ledge with a lip,” Lark replied with relief.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

**gap**

“Lowercase l begins lip,” Lark explained softly. “Touch your tongue just behind your top teeth and let your voice flow: /l/. Don't add an extra vowel. Join l, i, p. On this diagram, lip means the little raised edge that stops a letter sliding off.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try lip, leg, log, lap, let. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Find lip on the shelf sketch,” Lark invited gently. “Which edge could help our envelope stay flat?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam let Pat hop. Pat did hop.**

“Who did the hopping?” Lark asked gently. “Use the second sentence to check.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

One empty tray covered a lower flat space behind the retaining lip. Nib shifted that tray to an unused support and left the working tins alone. The envelope now had somewhere level to wait. Before posting it, Lark checked the collection diagram. A marked reply box beneath the bench still needed identifying.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write l beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the ledge with its useful lip. The Mill invitation remained retrievable beside the crew, and the Fern Lodge envelope stayed packed. A better shelf was ready; the right box was next.